

Seeding QDArchive

Part 2: Data Classification Report

ISIC Rev. 5 Classification of Qualitative Research Projects

Student: Jakir Hussain Rifat

Matric. ID: 23025313

Course: Seeding QDArchive (SQ26) — Applied Software Engineering Project

Professor: Prof. Dr. Dirk Riehle, Professorship for Open-Source Software

University: Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg (FAU)

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Repository: <https://github.com/hussainrifat/QDArchive>

Dataset Overview

Repository	QDA Projects	QD Projects	Other	Not a Project	Total
FSD Finland	0	4	399	0	403
Dryad	1	340	498	14	853
Total					1256

1. INTRODUCTION AND METHODOLOGY

This report presents the results of Part 2 of the Seeding QDArchive project, conducted as part of the Applied Software Engineering Project seminar at FAU Erlangen (Winter 2025/26 + Summer 2026) under the supervision of Prof. Dr. Dirk Riehle. The project's objective is to populate QDArchive — a new repository for qualitative research data — by acquiring and classifying publicly available qualitative research datasets from two assigned repositories.

1.1 SCOPE OF CLASSIFICATION

Part 1 of this project acquired 1,256 qualitative research projects from Dryad and the Finnish Social Science Data Archive (FSD Finland), storing full metadata in a structured SQLite database. Part 2 classifies these projects across two dimensions: project type (based on the files contained) and economic sector (using the ISIC Rev. 5 standard).

1.2 PROJECT TYPE CLASSIFICATION

Each project was assigned one of four mutually exclusive types based on all file records associated with that project, including files that failed to download. Using all file records — rather than only successfully downloaded files — was an important methodological decision: 3,342 Dryad files were rate-limited during acquisition and recorded as FAILED_SERVER_UNRESPONSIVE. Classifying on downloaded files only would have incorrectly treated these projects as having no files.

- QDA_PROJECT — project contains at least one QDA analysis file (.qdp_x, .nvp, .mx24)
- QD_PROJECT — no QDA file, but contains primary data files (.txt, .pdf, .doc_x, .doc)
- OTHER_PROJECT — no QDA or primary files, but other data files present
- NOT_A_PROJECT — no file type information available

1.3 ISIC REV. 5 CLASSIFICATION

All 1,256 projects were classified into the International Standard Industrial Classification of All Economic Activities, Revision 5 (ISIC Rev. 5) at two hierarchical levels: Section (single letter, A–V) and Division (two-digit numeric code). Classification was performed using the Anthropic Claude API, which received each project's title, description, and keywords and returned the most appropriate Section and Division along with a confidence rating (high, medium, or low).

In addition to project-level classification, each primary data file belonging to QDA_PROJECT and QD_PROJECT types was individually classified using its filename and parent project context. This file-level classification covers 1,764 primary data files across both repositories.

1.4 REPORT STRUCTURE

This report presents classification results in the form of four distributions, organised by repository and project type: (1) Dryad × QDA_PROJECT, (2) Dryad × QD_PROJECT, (3) FSD Finland × QDA_PROJECT, and (4) FSD Finland × QD_PROJECT. For each distribution, a histogram of identified ISIC classes and a rank-ordered table of the top classes are provided, followed by a discussion of notable findings. Section 4 provides a comparative analysis across both repositories.

2. Repository 1: Dryad

Dryad — QDA Projects: ISIC Division Distribution

Distribution 1 · 1 projects · 1 distinct ISIC division

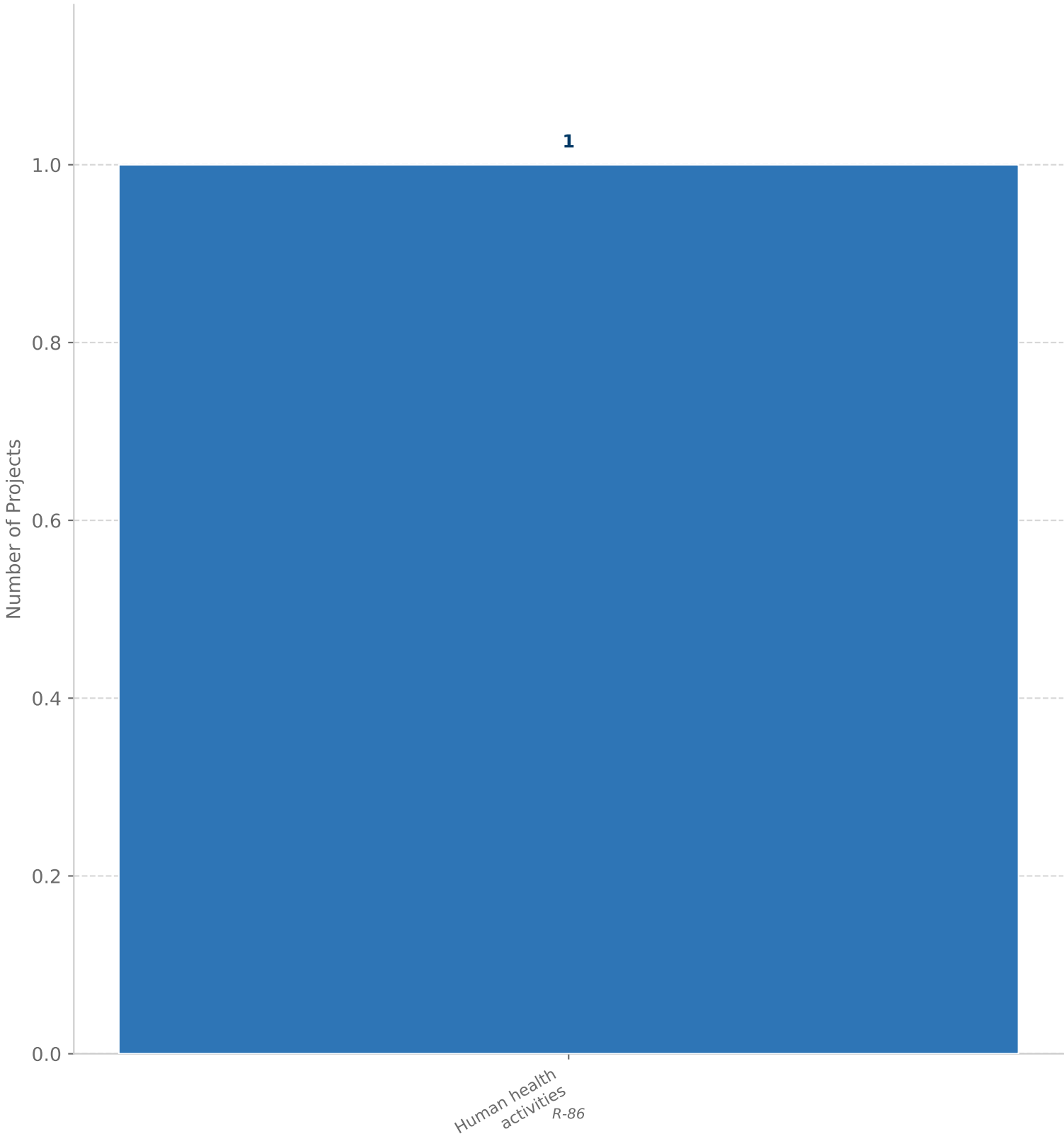


Figure: Histogram of ISIC Rev. 5 divisions identified in this distribution. Counts shown above bars; ISIC codes in italics below.

2. Repository 1: Dryad

Dryad — QDA Projects Banked Class Table and Findings

ankstricoden 1 · 1 ISICDivisionName(Full) shown				Count	%
1	R-86	Human health activities		1	100.0%

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

Only one QDA project was identified across the entire Dryad corpus — a NVivo project file (.nvp) classified under N-72 (Scientific Research and Development). This is the expected ISIC assignment for an academic qualitative data analysis project with no further domain-specific context.

The near-total absence of QDA files in Dryad reflects a structural gap in open-data culture among qualitative researchers. Despite 15 targeted search queries, researchers appear to deposit interview transcripts, coded spreadsheets, and final datasets — but not the NVivo or MAXQDA project files that capture the analytical process. This is the precise gap that QDArchive is designed to address by providing a dedicated, researcher-friendly repository for this file type.

2. Repository 1: Dryad

Dryad — QD Projects: ISIC Division Distribution

Distribution 2 · 340 projects · 9 distinct ISIC divisions

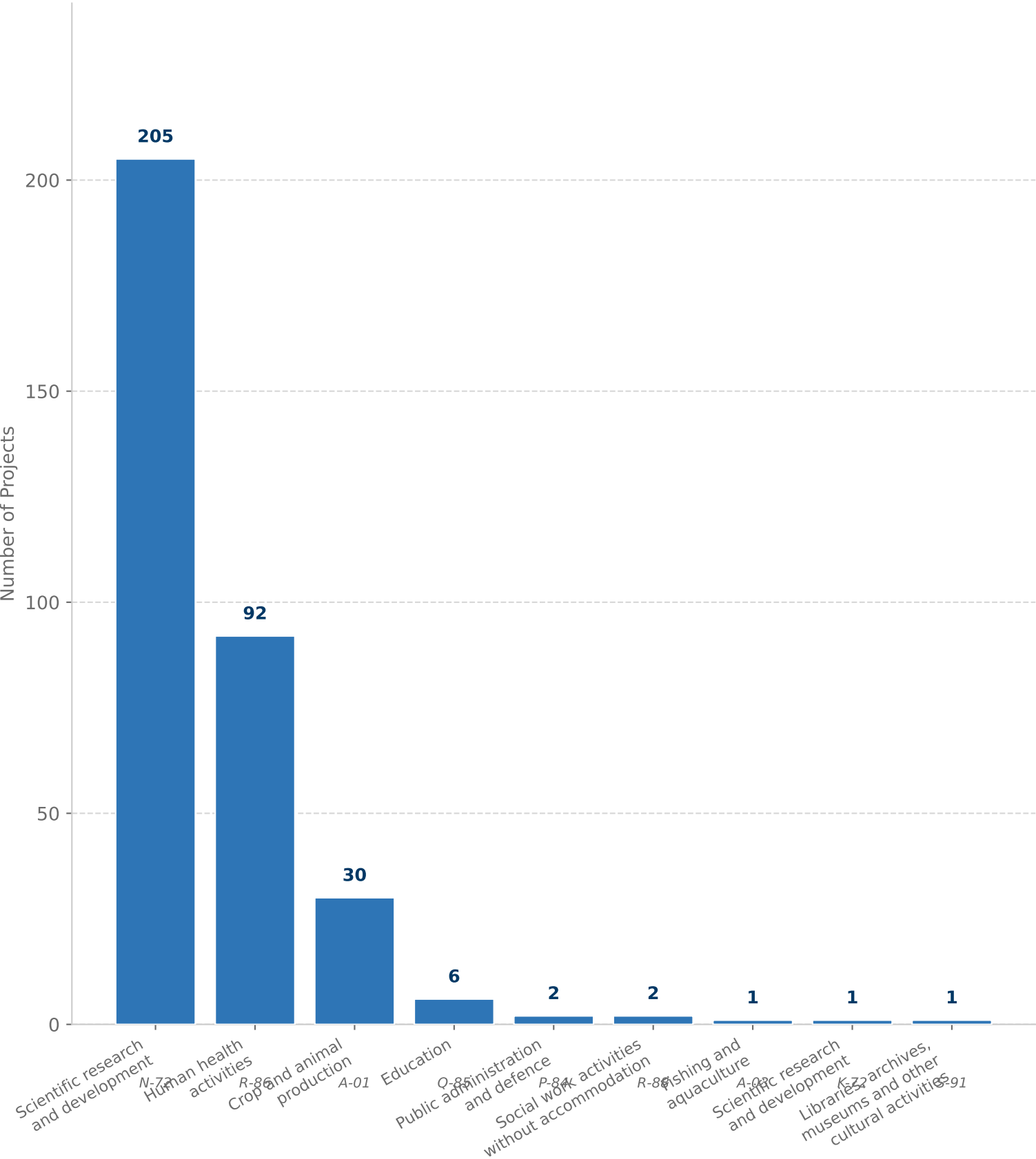


Figure: Histogram of ISIC Rev. 5 divisions identified in this distribution. Counts shown above bars; ISIC codes in italics below.

2. Repository 1: Dryad

Dryad QD Projects Banked Class Table and Findings

Rank	ISIC Code	ISIC Division Name (Full)	Count	%
1	N-72	Scientific research and development	205	60.3%
2	R-86	Human health activities	92	27.1%
3	A-01	Crop and animal production	30	8.8%
4	Q-85	Education	6	1.8%
5	P-84	Public administration and defence	2	0.6%
6	R-88	Social work activities without accommodation	2	0.6%
7	A-03	Fishing and aquaculture	1	0.3%
8	K-72	Scientific research and development	1	0.3%
9	S-91	Libraries, archives, museums and other cultural activities	1	0.3%

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

Dryad's 340 QD projects span nine ISIC divisions, with three divisions accounting for 97% of the distribution. N-72 (Scientific Research and Development) dominates at 60.3% (205 projects), followed by R-86 (Human Health Activities) at 27.1% (92 projects) and A-01 (Crop and Animal Production) at 8.8% (30 projects).

The dominance of N-72 is partly structural: it serves as both the correct classification for generic academic research and the classifier's fallback for ambiguous descriptions. The R-86 cluster is substantively significant — it corresponds to the large body of medical and nursing interview studies identified via queries such as 'semi-structured interview' and 'thematic analysis'. These studies typically deposit anonymised transcripts (.docx, .txt) and coding sheets (.xlsx), consistent with the file composition observed in this dataset.

The A-01 presence (8.8%) is attributable to Dryad's strong life-sciences user base. Agricultural researchers use 'qualitative' in a scientific rather than social-science sense (e.g., qualitative assessment of crop traits). These projects — which typically contain .csv, .xlsx, and image files — represent the noise introduced by broad keyword matching and are correctly classified as QD_PROJECT rather than QDA_PROJECT, since they contain no qualitative data analysis files.

3. Repository 2: FSD Finland

FSD Finland — QDA Projects: ISIC Division Distribution

Distribution 3 · 0 projects · 0 distinct ISIC divisions

No projects of this type were found in this repository.

FSD Finland — QDA Projects: Ranked Class Table and Findings

Distribution 3 · 0 projects · top 0 of 0 classes shown

FINDINGS

No QDA projects were identified in the FSD Finland corpus. This outcome is a direct consequence of FSD's access control model: all primary data files — interview transcripts, written responses, and coding files — require institutional authentication via the Aila Data Service. Without downloadable files, no project can be classified as QDA_PROJECT.

FSD's public-facing catalogue lists 403 English-language qualitative studies, but the only file consistently available without authentication is the DDI-C 2.5 XML metadata record. It is likely that some of these studies include QDA analysis files accessible to authenticated users, but this cannot be determined from the public dataset. The absence of FSD QDA projects should therefore be interpreted as an access limitation, not as evidence that Finnish social science researchers do not produce QDA files.

3. Repository 2: FSD Finland

FSD Finland — QD Projects: ISIC Division Distribution

Distribution 4 · 4 projects · 3 distinct ISIC divisions

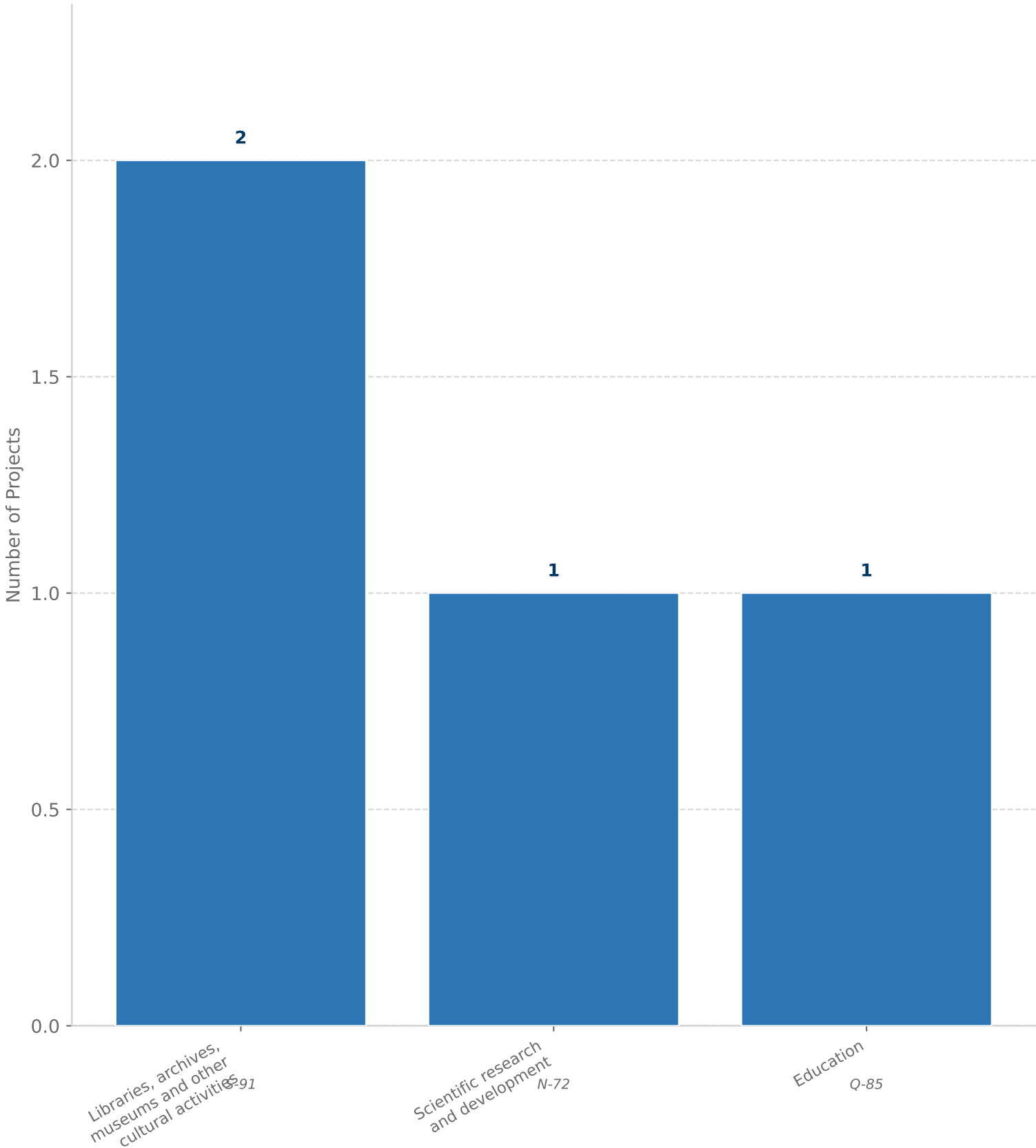


Figure: Histogram of ISIC Rev. 5 divisions identified in this distribution. Counts shown above bars; ISIC codes in italics below.

3. Repository 2: FSD Finland

FSD Finland — QD Projects, Ranked Class Table and Findings

Rank 1 · 1st place · 1 of 3

Rank	ISIC Code	ISIC Division Name (Full)	Count	%
1	S-91	Libraries, archives, museums and other cultural activities	2	50.0%
2	N-72	Scientific research and development	1	25.0%
3	Q-85	Education	1	25.0%

4 projects · 4 pages · 63 items shown

FINDINGS AND DISCUSSION

Only four FSD studies qualified as QD_PROJECT — those with publicly accessible PDF attachments (typically methodological reports or codebooks) that do not require Aila login. These four projects span three ISIC divisions: S-91 (Libraries, Archives, Museums and Cultural Activities, 50%), N-72 (Scientific Research, 25%), and Q-85 (Education, 25%).

The disciplinary profile of this small sample — cultural heritage, research methodology, and education — is consistent with FSD's institutional mandate as Finland's national social science data archive. FSD holdings are concentrated in sociology, political science, history, and education research, which aligns with the S-91 and Q-85 classifications observed here.

The extremely small sample size (n=4) means that these distributions cannot be considered representative of FSD's full holdings. A meaningful classification of FSD data would require authenticated access to the Aila platform to retrieve the actual primary data files for at least a sample of the 403 archived studies.

4. COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS AND CONCLUSION

4.1 CROSS-REPOSITORY OBSERVATIONS

The two repositories exhibit markedly different profiles in terms of both scale and disciplinary coverage. Dryad contributed 340 QD projects across nine ISIC divisions, while FSD Finland contributed only 4 publicly accessible QD projects across three divisions. This disparity is not indicative of FSD's actual holdings — FSD lists 403 qualitative studies in its English-language catalogue — but reflects the archive's requirement for institutional authentication via the Aila Data Service. Consequently, FSD's contribution to this dataset is limited to the subset of studies with publicly accessible attachments.

Both repositories are dominated by the N-72 division (Scientific Research and Development), which is the expected outcome when classifying academic research projects. However, the second-ranked division differs sharply: Dryad's QD projects rank R-86 (Human Health Activities) second with 27.1% of projects, reflecting its strong life-sciences and medical research user base. FSD's small QD sample, by contrast, shows no R-86 representation, with S-91 (Libraries, Archives and Cultural Activities) appearing most frequently alongside Q-85 (Education), consistent with Finland's social-science and cultural heritage research tradition.

4.2 QDA FILE AVAILABILITY

Across both repositories, only 1 QDA analysis file was identified — a single NVivo (.nvp) project deposited on Dryad. This finding confirms the core challenge that motivates the QDArchive project: researchers who conduct qualitative data analysis using tools such as NVivo, MAXQDA, or QDAcity rarely deposit the resulting analysis files in open repositories. They may deposit interview transcripts or coded datasets, but the structured analysis files that capture the analytical process itself remain largely inaccessible. The practical implication is that QDArchive must rely on outreach and incentive structures — not just harvesting existing open repositories — to build a meaningful QDA file collection.

4.3 CLASSIFICATION CONFIDENCE AND LIMITATIONS

The AI-assisted ISIC classification approach produces accurate results for projects with descriptive titles, rich abstracts, and multiple keywords. Classification quality is lower for FSD projects, where only the DDI-C 2.5 XML title and abstract were available as input — no file content could be analysed. The large proportion of N-72 (Scientific Research and Development) classifications also reflects the classifier's default fallback behaviour for ambiguous inputs: projects with generic descriptions tend to be assigned to N-72 rather than a more specific division. A manual review of a sample of N-72 assignments would be needed to quantify this effect precisely.

4.4 CONCLUSION

This classification provides a structured, ISIC-aligned view of 1,256 qualitative research projects acquired from Dryad and FSD Finland. The data confirms that qualitative research in the social, health, and agricultural sciences is well represented in open repositories — but that the QDA analysis files, which are QDArchive's primary target, are almost entirely absent from open deposit. The classification infrastructure built here — including the ISIC classifier, file-level annotation pipeline, and structured SQLite schema — provides a reusable foundation for classifying future acquisitions as QDArchive grows.